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Erich Krauss
Victory Belt Publishing

Dear Erich,

*This is the book I couldn't write yet.*

Fourteen years and five restarts after I turned in the manuscript that should not have been published — and that I am still grateful did not — I am sending you the book that has actually been trying to get out the whole time. It is called *The Sustainability Diet: Accounting for Survivability*, and it is not the book I gave you in 2012. It is what fourteen years of standards-writing, reading, and changing my mind about most of what I thought I knew has finally produced.

The argument, in two words, is that *survivability matters*. The longer version is a four-axis framework for evaluating food systems — economic viability, social fit, environmental fit, and the missing fourth axis the book exists to argue for: how the system performs when the conditions change. The framework gets applied to every food system worth evaluating, from industrial grain monoculture to indigenous foodways to closed-loop urban aquaponics, and it ends in a hypothesis the reader can argue with: that one of the food systems that scores best on all four axes is one we lost twelve and a half thousand years ago, and could choose to bring back. The reader who finds that ridiculous now is the reader I am writing for.

The book is approximately 70,000 words across thirteen chapters plus a Prologue and Epilogue. It has been built to the structural standards I would want from a book I was reading: the framework is named early, the contested-science questions (Pleistocene rewilding, the empirical record on holistic management, the resilience-thinking literature) are engaged on the page rather than ducked, and the author's professional vantage is disclosed in the front matter rather than buried in the Acknowledgments. The Acknowledgments includes the apology to you. I meant it. I would like the chance to write the next book with you instead of in spite of you.

Attached: the manuscript in .docx for editorial work, a typeset PDF of the same content for ease of reading (the sidebars in this book do structural work and read more naturally typeset than inline), an About the Book sheet for your team, and a wrap-cover mockup for visual register only. Final design and layout are yours.

Thank you for reading.

With gratitude,

KAREN PENDERGRASS

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